Live Football Analytics with a Streaming Data Pipeline

ID2221 Data-Intensive Computing — Project Report, Group 28

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1 What we did

We built an end-to-end streaming pipeline that turns a raw stream of football match events into a live, minute-by-minute view of *which team is on top*. Recorded matches are replayed as if they were live: a producer sends every event to Kafka at its original timing (optionally sped up), Spark Structured Streaming computes per-team statistics over sliding windows of match time, the results are upserted into MongoDB, and a web dashboard receives every change through a MongoDB Change Stream and redraws its charts within seconds. Everything runs locally with Docker Compose.

2 Dataset

We use **StatsBomb Open Data** (`https://github.com/statsbomb/open-data`), event data from the FIFA World Cup 2022 (competition 43, season 106). Each match is a JSON list of timestamped events (passes, pressures, shots with expected goals (xG), ...). We use three group-stage matches: Canada–Morocco 1–2 (3 388 events), England–Iran 6–2 (3 649) and Croatia–Belgium 0–0 (4 116), 8.9 MB in total. The data is not included in the zip; `scripts/download_statsbomb.py --limit 3` downloads exactly these matches.

3 Methodology

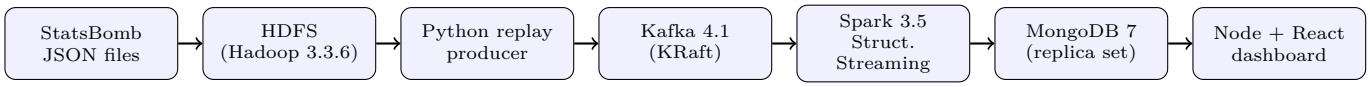


Figure 1: Pipeline architecture. All components run as Docker containers on one machine.

Storage and replay. The raw files are stored in HDFS. The producer reads matches through WebHDFS and sends each event to the Kafka topic `football-events`, keyed by match id so a match stays in order within one partition. It keeps the original gaps between events, divided by a `--speed` factor, and can replay several matches concurrently. Each message carries an *event time* (kickoff + elapsed match time, half-time skipped) and the wall-clock send time `sent_at` for latency measurement.

Stream processing. A PySpark Structured Streaming job (standalone cluster, one worker with 2 cores) parses the messages and counts, per match replay and team, shots, shots on target, goals, xG, pressures and passes over **sliding event-time windows** of 5 minutes that advance every minute. Because windows are defined on match time, the results are identical at any replay speed. We use *update* output mode, so every micro-batch emits only the windows that changed, and a `foreachBatch` sink replaces each window's MongoDB document by its key (`match|kickoff|team|window_start`). This upsert is idempotent, so a batch re-run after a failure does not double count. Spark's state and Kafka offsets are checkpointed in HDFS.

Dashboard. MongoDB runs as a single-node replica set because Change Streams require the oplog. A Node.js server sends a snapshot of all windows to each browser, then pushes every change over a WebSocket; a React client draws one line per team for each statistic (Figure 2).

Evaluation. (i) *Results:* `evaluation/match_summary.py` aggregates the windows of each match. (ii) *Correctness:* we recomputed every window directly from the raw JSON and compared it with Spark's output. (iii) *Latency:* `evaluation/latency.py` watches the Change Stream and records, for every update, the time since the producer sent the newest event in that window (end-to-end: producer → Kafka → Spark → MongoDB → consumer). Hardware: Apple-silicon laptop, 8 GB RAM, 3.8 GB for Docker.

4 Results

Football results. Table 1 summarizes what the pipeline found. *Pressed more* is the share of match minutes in which a team made more pressures than its opponent in the 5-minute window. In all three matches **the team with less of the ball did the pressing**: Morocco, Croatia and Iran out-pressed their opponents in 55–66% of the minutes, while Canada, Belgium and England had more passes. **Creating chances is not the same as winning:** Canada (xG 1.10 vs. 0.41) and Belgium (2.39 vs. 0.68, 16 shots) created more but did not win, while England turned an xG of 1.99 into six goals. The time series also show *when* things happened (Figure 2): Morocco pressed hardest in minutes 2–7, when they scored first; Canada dominated possession from minute 50 to 75 and had their best chance around minute 73 (xG 0.73), before Morocco's pressing rose again to close out the win.



Figure 2: Live dashboard for Canada–Morocco: pressures, passes, shots and xG per team in the last 5 minutes, plotted against the match minute.

Match (score)	Team	Passes	Pressures	Pressed more	Shots	xG	Goals
Canada–Morocco (1–2)	Canada	**562**	135	37%	5	**1.10**	0
	Morocco	393	**154**	**55%**	7	0.41	**2**
Belgium–Croatia (0–0)	Belgium	**630**	119	27%	**16**	**2.39**	0
	Croatia	609	**164**	**66%**	11	0.68	0
England–Iran (6–2)	England	**846**	101	28%	**13**	**1.99**	**6**
	Iran	247	**141**	**59%**	8	1.45	2

Table 1: Whole-match totals computed from Spark's windows (non-overlapping windows summed). Morocco's own goal in Canada's favour is not a Canada shot.

Correctness. For three matches replayed concurrently, all 653 windows matched the batch recomputation exactly (0 missing, 0 extra, 0 differing values); two consecutive replays of the same match also matched exactly.

Latency. With one match, the median end-to-end latency is about 5 s regardless of speed (Table 2): Spark keeps up, and latency is dominated by the fixed cost of a micro-batch (scheduling, state checkpoint to HDFS, MongoDB write) rather than by data volume. Slower replays give more updates (each window is rewritten in more batches), so the dashboard moves more smoothly. Three concurrent matches double the median to 9.7 s, since each batch must update more windows and state on the 2-core worker.

Configuration	Updates	Median	p95	Max
1 match, speed 10	1088	4.9 s	9.5 s	16.4 s
1 match, speed 60	362	5.1 s	10.0 s	13.0 s
3 matches, speed 30	1154	9.7 s	20.7 s	29.7 s

Table 2: End-to-end latency, one run per configuration (`evaluation/results.csv`).

Lessons learned. (1) Replaying faster than real time makes event time run ahead of the clock, so a new replay started "behind" Spark's global watermark and was dropped as late data; a 2 h watermark (longer than any match) fixes this without delaying output in update mode. (2) Overlapping replays of the same match were merged until the kickoff was added to the window key. (3) `startingOffsets=latest` skips events sent before the first micro-batch. (4) Spark's `current_timestamp()` is fixed at batch start, so we measure latency at the consumer. *Limitations:* one run per configuration on one laptop; more workers and tuning are future work.

5 How to run

Requirements: Docker Desktop (about 4 GB memory), Python 3 with `pymongo` for the evaluation scripts. Full details are in `README.md`.

```
python3 scripts/download_statsbomb.py --limit 3     # dataset -> data/
docker compose up -d                                # HDFS, Kafka, Spark, MongoDB, dashboard
./scripts/create_topics.sh && ./scripts/upload_to_hdfs.sh
./scripts/run_spark_job.sh --reset                  # terminal 1; wait for "batch 0"
docker compose run --rm producer --speed 10         # terminal 2; no --match = all 3 matches
open http://localhost:3000                          # live dashboard
python3 evaluation/latency.py --label "1 match"     # start before the producer; Ctrl+C after
python3 evaluation/match_summary.py                 # after a replay -> match_summary.csv
```